

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

RIFTED APART

Maharashtra chief minister **Uddhav Thackeray's** relationship with his predecessor **Devendra Fadnavis** has been at an all-time low ever since the Shiv Sena ditched the BJP to form the government with the Congress and NCP in 2019. Since then, Thackeray seems to have gone out of his way to avoid any contact with Fadnavis. Not only is he yet to make a single phone call to the leader of Opposition, he did not invite him for the inauguration of Mumbai's second metro line on April 2 either, in a departure from protocol. And, in the recently-concluded budget session of the state legislature, the CM avoided eye contact with Fadnavis at the Assembly House. Political observers feel it might be safe to put to rest any speculations of a BJP-Sena reunion.

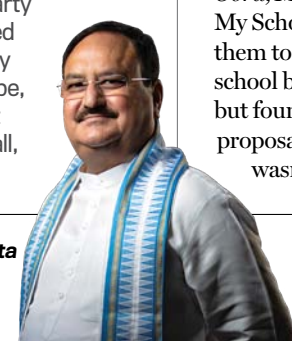
Caught in the Crossfire

Rajasthan wildlife board member Sunil Mehta recently invited **Sachin Tendulkar** and his wife **Anjali** to visit tiger reserves in the state in the hope that they would bring in publicity. Sachin was unable to accept, but Anjali's visit to Ranthambore and Sariska trended on social media. Unfortunately, a fire in Sariska on her last day led to field director R.N. Meena being unfairly criticised for focusing on Anjali rather than the fire. Needless to say, she was not happy about the negative attention.



OUT OF TUNE?

It was a rare treat to see TMC Rajya Sabha MPs brushing shoulders with their BJP counterparts at the farewell ceremony of 72 upper house members set to retire in July. This bonhomie, though, went off-key when TMC's Dola Sen sang a solo—Tagore's 'Bidhir Badhan katbe tumi eamon Shaktiman? (How powerful are you to challenge the predestined?)'. Though a clear dig at the BJP (PM Narendra Modi being the 'powerful' one), the saffron party president **J.P. Nadda** seemed to be enjoying the music. Many said he was oblivious to the jibe, but some argued he might not have been so clueless. After all, he is married to a Bengali.



—Kaushik Deka with Kiran D. Tare, Rohit Parihar, Romita Datta, Amitabh Srivastava & Amarnath K. Menon



HOUSE HUNTING

In October 2021, **Chirag Paswan** lost the LJP's bungalow symbol after the Election Commission put a freeze on it. On March 30, he lost the real thing when he was made to vacate the 12, Janpath, bungalow that was allotted to his father Ram Vilas Paswan in 1990. Chirag—who once declared himself Modi's Hanuman—has accused the government of disrespecting the memory of his late father. With one bungalow gone, is Chirag looking for a new home? Meanwhile, he has already thanked "younger brother Tejashwi" for taking a stand on his eviction.

Bitter Lesson



During a US tour in March, Telangana industries minister **K.T. Rama Rao** got American IT, electronics, food processing, life sciences and pharma companies to commit to investments worth Rs 7,000 crore. While there, Rao also attempted to inspire NRIs from Telangana to help the 26,065 rural government schools under the state's *Mana Ooru, Mana Badi* (My Village, My School) scheme by getting them to pledge funds to upgrade school buildings and libraries, but found few takers for the proposal. Was it because it wasn't strictly business?